

The Anger Iceberg

Greater Nashua Mental Health Center

Instructions: Anger is often the visible 'tip of the iceberg' — underneath it are softer or more vulnerable emotions that are harder to show. Identifying what's beneath your anger helps you respond to the real need.

Above the surface

The situation, and how my anger showed up (words, tone, body, actions):

Below the surface — what's underneath?

Check any feelings that may be hiding beneath the anger:

- | | | |
|---|--|--|
| ☐ Hurt | ☐ Fear / anxiety | ☐ Embarrassment / shame |
| ☐ Disrespected | ☐ Sadness / grief | ☐ Rejection |
| ☐ Helplessness | ☐ Guilt | ☐ Jealousy |
| ☐ Disappointment | ☐ Feeling unheard | ☐ Overwhelm |

Which of these feels most true right now, and what does it tell me I need?

A more direct way to express the underlying feeling or need: